



ENGINEERING
TEXAS A&M UNIVERSITY

**2026 Spring Semester
Engineering Project
Showcase
Student Guidebook**

Industry & Nonprofit Partnerships (INP)

inp@tamu.edu

[Student EPS Portal Link](#)

2026 Spring Semester Engineering Project Showcase

STUDENT GUIDEBOOK

February 1st – February 28th, 2026

Team Registration

March 23rd – March 27th, 2026

Team Confirmation of
Participation

April 24th, 2026

Engineering Project Showcase

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Howdy Engineering Students!

Thank you for your interest in the 2026 Engineering Project Showcase (EPS). The goal of this competition is to showcase the innovative work of engineering undergraduate students to a wide range of industries, nonprofit organizations, and government agencies. This guidebook is designed to support students in preparing for the showcase. For questions, please email us at inp@tamu.edu.

Background Information

Since 2012, the College of Engineering at Texas A&M University has provided engineering undergraduates with two annual opportunities to showcase team projects with industry:

- **Fall Semester - Virtual Project Showcase** – Participating teams submit short videos about their projects and industry representatives review and judge videos remotely.
- **Spring Semester - Engineering Project Showcase** – Participating teams and judges meet onsite at the Zachry Engineering Education Complex and teams present their project work with prototypes and posters.

Both events aim to:

- **Celebrate student innovation** — Showcase the creativity, rigor, and impact of engineering students through senior capstone projects that address real-world challenges.
- **Engage industry professionals** — Involve industry partners as judges, giving students meaningful opportunities to present their work, discuss design decisions, and receive valuable professional feedback.
- **Raise awareness of sponsored capstone opportunities** — Increase awareness of sponsored capstone projects as a scalable, high-impact model for industry collaboration that advances innovation, workforce development, and applied research.

The 2026 Spring Engineering Project Showcase will take place on Friday, April 24, 2026, at the Zachry Engineering Education Center. 1,000+ graduating engineering students are expected to attend and present their capstone projects through posters and prototypes to more than 200 judges from industry. Check out this [short video](#) from a past event.



Figure 1 Zachry Engineering Education Complex



Figure 2 Fischer Engineering Design Center

Background Information (Continued)

The annual Showcase events have grown significantly in number of participating students, as well as the number of industry judges supporting the events, as seen in Figures 3 and 4 below for the past five years.

Since 2012: 3,206 Teams - 15,829 Students - 2,454 Industry Guests

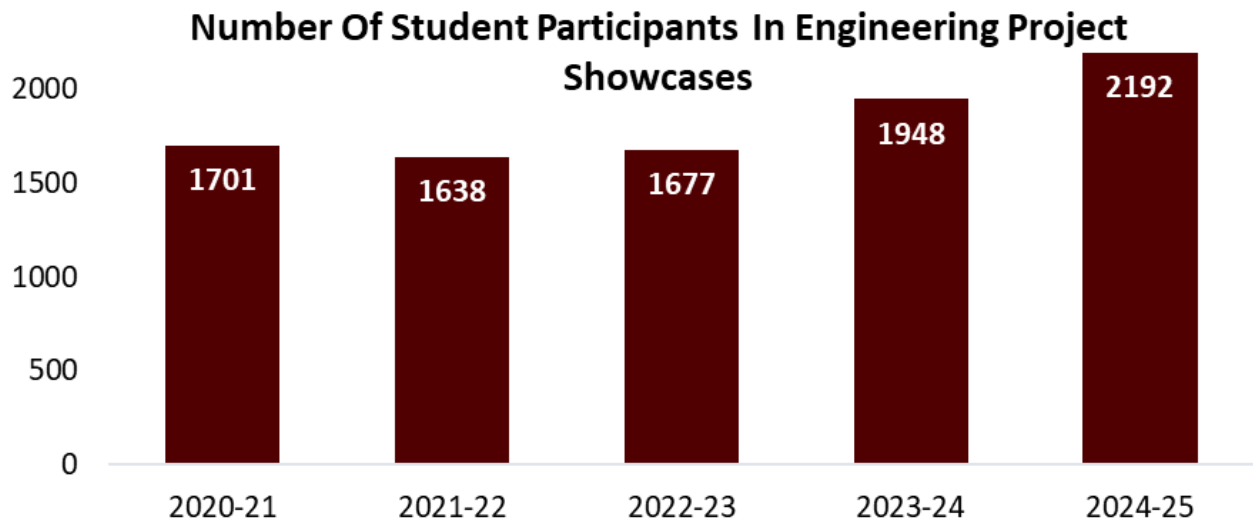


Figure 3 Student Data

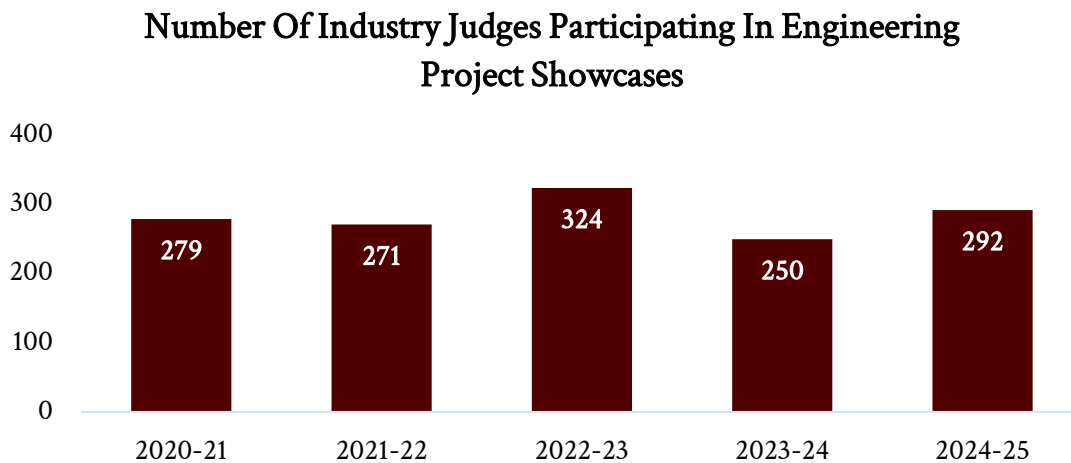


Figure 4 Industry Support of Showcase Events

For a list of organizations represented by judges at recent Engineering Project Showcase events, check page 14.

Past Showcase Event Images





Event Schedule (Tentative)

The final event schedule will be posted on the official Engineering Project Showcase website (link is posted on the cover of this guidebook) and communicated via email to all registered teams.

- **8:00 AM – 10:00 AM** Team Registration / Booth Setup, *ConocoPhillips Atrium, ZACH*
- **10:30 AM – 1:30 PM** Judging
- **3:00 PM** Awards Ceremony, *Chevron Rooms, ZACH*

Awards

Each team will be assigned a minimum of three industry judges. Awards will be given to teams with the highest average judge scores.

Overall Senior Capstone Awards		
1st Prize	2nd Prize	3rd Prize
\$2,000	\$1,750	\$1,500

In Major Senior Capstone Awards (15+ entries)		
1st Prize	2nd Prize	3rd Prize
\$1,000	\$750	\$500

In Major Senior Capstone Awards (10-14 entries)		
1st Prize	2nd Prize	3rd Prize
\$500	\$350	\$250

Judging Criteria

Each submission will be judged by at least three judges, and the winning teams will be identified based on average total scores for four areas shown below.

Problem Definition & Context (20%)
Outcomes & Engineering Rigor (35%)

Methodology & Technical Approach (30%)
Poster & Communication Quality (15%)

2026 Spring Engineering Project Showcase Judging Rubric

		Not Satisfactory (1)	Satisfactory (2)	Good (3)	Very Good (4)	Exemplary (5)
Problem Definition & Context	Problem Definition & Impact <i>Demonstrates understanding of existing solutions and their limitations or lack of solutions.</i>	Problem statement is unclear or missing; impact is not addressed.	Problem and impact are mentioned but lack clarity or focus.	Problem and expected impact are clearly defined and understandable.	Problem and impact are well defined, relevant, and logically framed.	Problem and impact are articulated clearly, concisely, and compellingly, demonstrating strong relevance and purpose.
	Understanding of Existing Solutions <i>Demonstrates awareness of prior art, existing solutions, and their limitations.</i>	No discussion of existing solutions or prior work.	Limited mention of existing solutions with minimal discussion of limitations.	A clear description of existing solutions and their limitations or lack of solutions are given.	Existing solutions and limitations are well explained and logically connected to the proposed project.	Insightful and concise analysis of existing solutions that clearly justifies the need for the proposed approach.
Methodology & Technical Approach	Approach to Solving the Problem <i>Demonstrates a structured and logical plan for addressing the problem.</i>	No clear approach or methodology is presented.	Approach is briefly described but lacks clarity or structure.	Approach is clearly defined and appropriate for the problem.	Approach is clearly articulated, well structured, and logically justified.	Exceptionally clear and compelling approach that demonstrates strong engineering judgment and engages the audience.
	Technical Depth of Proposed Solution <i>Design solution demonstrates appropriate rigor, detail, and use of engineering principles.</i>	Proposed solution is unclear or lacks technical explanation.	Solution is described with limited technical depth.	Solution is clearly defined and includes sufficient technical detail.	Solution demonstrates strong technical depth and appropriate use of engineering methods and practices.	Solution exceeds expectations in technical depth, offering insight, innovation, or advanced understanding of the problem.

2026 Spring Engineering Project Showcase Judging Rubric (continued)						
		Not Satisfactory (1)	Satisfactory (2)	Good (3)	Very Good (4)	Exemplary (5)
Outcomes & Engineering Rigor	Quality of Prototype, Model, or Analysis <i>Deliverables are supported by sound engineering analysis.</i>	Poor quality deliverable with little or no engineering analysis.	Adequate deliverable supported by limited engineering analysis.	Good quality prototype or model with clear explanations and supporting analysis.	High-quality deliverable supported by substantial and well-executed engineering analysis.	Exemplary deliverable that exceeds expectations, offering insight, innovation, and rigorous engineering validation.
	Consideration of Practical Constraints <i>Considers factors such as manufacturability, cost, sustainability, safety, or scalability.</i>	Practical constraints are not addressed.	Practical factors are briefly mentioned with limited analysis.	Relevant practical factors are adequately considered and support the solution.	Clear and thoughtful consideration of practical constraints and tradeoffs.	In-depth, well-reasoned analysis of practical constraints demonstrating real-world engineering judgment.
Poster & Communication Quality	Organization and Clarity of Poster <i>Poster clearly communicates the project from problem to solution.</i>	Poster is disorganized and difficult to follow.	Poster is understandable but lacks clear structure.	Poster is clear, organized, and easy to follow.	Poster is well organized, engaging, and enhances understanding of the project.	Exceptionally organized and engaging poster that adds significant value to the overall presentation.
	Use of Visual Aids <i>Visuals effectively support communication and understanding.</i>	Visual aids are missing, unclear, or ineffective.	Some visual aids are present and generally support the project.	Visual aids are clear, relevant, and support understanding.	Visual aids significantly enhance clarity and effectiveness of the presentation.	Visual aids are exemplary, offering additional insight and greatly strengthening the communication of the solution.

Team Registration & Participation

Phase I – Team Registration – All teams interested in participating in the EPS competition need to register their teams in the portal by the deadline, February 28th, 2026, at midnight.

Phase II – Attendance Confirmation – Each team needs to confirm their attendance from March 23rd – March 27th, 2026, by going on the EPS Website.

Primary vs Additional Team Members – Before registration, each team must select a team member (primary team member) who will represent the team and handle team registration and attendance confirmation. The primary team member will receive all notifications about the event and is expected to share the details with all team members. All other members will be known as additional members and will be added by the primary member in the registration form that he/she submits online. All members will be recognized, and prizes awarded will be equally divided to all members.

Phase I – Team Registration (February 1st – 28th, 2026)

During this phase, the primary member will register the team by going into the “Team Portal” tab, via the link on page 2, and click on TAMU SSO. Once there, the following information will be entered into the portal:

- **Project Title** – This information will be used to identify your team. Examples: 1) “Halliburton Heat Treatment Project”
- **Project Category** – Select your project category. After selecting your Category, you may be prompted to select a subcategory.
- **Project Description** – The description (550 – 700 characters) will be viewed by judges before talking to your team at the Showcase, as well as included in the Showcase Booklet
- **Add Team Members** – Enter here additional team members’ details (first name, last name, and their TAMU email). Add the primary member information again.
- **Faculty Advisor Name** – Provide the name of the faculty instructor or faculty working with the team.
- **Project Sponsor** – Enter here the name of the organization sponsoring your project. Examples: Shell, Boeing, etc. If the project is sponsored by a faculty, please enter the name of the faculty’s department. Also, please notify your sponsor about your intent to participate in the EPS competition and get their approval.
- **Electricity Requirements** – Teams requiring power to support their prototype may request access to power. Due to the limited number of outlets, we will not be able to provide access to all teams. Please charge your laptops and mobile devices before the event.
- **Additional Space Requirements / Outside Booths** – All teams will be provided access to an easel for their poster and a booth to display prototypes. Teams displaying large prototypes that do not fit on top of the booth may request additional space for a booth inside ZACH or request space outside ZACH.
- **Save** – If you plan to make changes to the information provided, please press ‘Save’. You will be able to edit this information until the deadline, February 28th, 2026, midnight.
- **Save & Finalize** – When all team information is complete, the primary member can press ‘Save & Finalize’ to submit the team registration.

Please note that your registration will not be complete until the ‘Save & Finalize’ button has been clicked. You will NOT be able to make any changes after you have clicked the ‘Save & Finalize’ button.

Phase II – Attendance Confirmation (March 23rd – March 27th, 2026)

Before finalizing the judge assignments for the event, we need to ensure that all registered teams are planning to attend the event. Subsequently, we ask that each team confirms their attendance online from March 23rd – 27th, 2026. You will be receiving an email notification regarding this.

Other Helpful Information

Creating Quality Posters

Poster Guidelines

- **Dimension Range:** 30" (min) - 36" (max) tall by 40" (min) - 48" (max) wide. (Length and width might be interchangeable depending on the orientation of your poster).
- **Use text, charts, pictures, diagrams, and/or figures to describe your work**
- **Poster Title:** Project Title (must match the title used for team registration), Team members – list the team members involved in the project (first initial, last name, department acronym). Ex. A. Jones (MEEN), Professor(s) – list the professor(s) involved in the project and their department acronym (Dr., first initial, last name, home department acronym) Ex. Dr. A. Engineer (AERO), Industry Sponsor Company, Department.
- **Sections:** Objective/Purpose, Methodology, Results, Discussion, Conclusions, and Acknowledgments (optional).
- **Text:** Font must be large enough so that words can be read from 3-4 feet away. All text should be at least 20-30 pt. Use bold on headings. Headings should be at least 30- 40 pt. Recommended fonts are Times New Roman, Arial, or Helvetica as they are easy to read.
- **Template:** You can find a poster template on the Showcase Portal. While sizing your poster, please be aware that you get a 36X48" foam board to which you will attach your project poster using push pins.
- **Logo:** You should include the project sponsor logo, if applicable. Do NOT use the Texas A&M University Seal
 - Fonts: Texas A&M style guide for suggested fonts
 - <https://marcomm.tamu.edu/our-brand/visual-style/aggie-brand-fonts/>
 - Color Palette: If you choose to incorporate Aggie Maroon, use the CMYK formula:
 - C = 15
 - M = 100
 - Y = 39
 - K = 69
 - *For accent colors and RGB (used for electronic media) Aggie Maroon
<https://marcomm.tamu.edu/our-brand/visual-style/brand-colors/>

Printing Location and Contact Information - Students are responsible for the cost of printing the poster. See below locations for poster printing. Most posters take at least a day to print (expect longer times at the end of the semester), plan accordingly.

- College of Engineering - Located on the third floor of the Zachry Building
(Contact ENGR-posters@tamu.edu)

- FedEx Office - Located on University Dr. across from the Northside Parking Garage near the intersection of Asbury St.
(Contact no. 979-846-8721)
- Copy Corner – Located at the corner of Texas Ave. and Manuel Dr.
(Contact no. 979-694-COPY)
- Office Depot Print Center – Located inside Office Depot on Texas Ave.
(Contact no. 979-695-0763)
- Student Computing Center (SCC) – Located next to Evans Library/Annex
(Contact no. 979-845-8306)
- College of Architecture – Located on the first floor of the Langford Building
(Contact no. 979-862-8584)

Dress Code

Business Professional.

- What to Wear: Dress slacks or khaki pants (not cargo pants), button-up shirt, polo, blouse, cardigan, sweater, suit jacket, blazer, sport coat, dress shoes, knee-length skirts and dresses, heels or dress flats.
- What Not to Wear: Cargo pants, jeans, shorts, short skirts, sweatpants, sweatshirts, t-shirts, sneakers, flip flops.

Remember that you will be standing for an extended period of time; wear comfortable clothes and footwear.

Poster/Prototype Setup

During check-in, you will receive your specific booth number and be provided with:

- One table/ tablecloth/ foam-core board /easel for your poster.
- Binder clips to attach your poster to your board.

At least TWO team members must be ALWAYS present. Team members may take shifts.

Awards Announcement

The winners of the 2026 Spring Engineering Project Showcase will be announced on April 24th, 2026, in the Zachry 297-299. Awards are processed as scholarships and will appear in your student accounts within two weeks of the award date. You can pull your award money out of your account by setting up your Texas A&M Direct Deposit.

Note: If you have a balance in your account, your award money will go towards your balance.

Intellectual Property

There are multiple ways to describe your project without disclosing confidential information. If this is a sponsored project, please request approval from the sponsor before submitting your project entry. If you have any questions, please contact us at inp@tamu.edu.

Appendix A - Past Judge Comments

Outstanding Job Team!!! Producing a functional model on time and under budget that the customer likes is the ultimate positive result for this type of project. Creative solution that meets all requirements. Love it! Only area is to enhance crumple zone prior to electric motor, so it does not get pushed into suspension system causing great repair costs.

2025 EPS Judge

This team demonstrated outstanding robustness to customer changing needs. They were able to pivot and develop solutions that demonstrated that they were on a path to meeting ultimate customer requirements. The team made decisions to rapid prototype and demonstrated several iterations of a design which has promised to informed and evolved concepts in the future. The team professionally discussed the methodology and design characteristics of their project.

2025 EPS Judge

This project was an excellent demonstration of identifying the problem (detection of low volume / low pressure escaping methane) and developing a solution with a working prototype. There is a significant commercial need for this technology and solution and you should consider commercial development and, importantly, expansion of the methodology for other applications.

2025 EPS Judge

Excellent presentation & remarkable group dynamic! Impressive that multiple models were configured/tested and 30% improvement over current methodologies were achieved.

2025 EPS Judge

Absolutely outstanding idea and presentation. Application of product was truly impressive, came back several times. This is a winner!

2025 EPS Judge

We look forward to seeing your posters and prototypes at the 2026 Spring Engineering Project Showcase competition!

Appendix B - Industry Judging Support

Table 1: Organizations Represented by Judges at the Previous Showcase Events		
12th Man Technology	Electric Power Research Institute, Inc. (EPRI)	OQ Chemicals
52Launch, LLC	ErgoGenesis Workplace	Pacific Northwest National Laboratory
75th U.S. Army Reserve Innovation Command	Exxon Mobil Corporation	Pantex Plant
Abbott	FlexRadio	Parkhill
Adamson Engineering, LLC	Flowco Production Solutions	Paroma Ventures
Advent GX Corporation	Fluor Corporation	Pathfinder Group, LLC
Aegis Aerospace	Forum Energy Technologies, Inc.	Peloton Computer Enterprises
AgQuarters	Frogslayer, LLC	Philips
American International Group, Inc. (AIG)	FUJIFILM Diosynth Biotechnologies Texas, LLC	Physia, Inc.
Air Force Technical Applications Center	G-CON Manufacturing, Inc.	Pike Engineering
Albers Aerospace	General Electric Global Research	Power Design, Inc.
RS Americas, Inc. (formerly known as Allied Electronics & Automation)	General Motors Company	PrimmTech Corporation
Altria Group, Inc.	Genis Holdings, LLC	PROCEANIC, LTD.
American Bureau of Shipping	Geophysical Technology, Inc.	Pumps and Pipes
Amount Small Business	GKN Aerospace	Pyraback COM
Anametric, Inc.	GMC Commissioning, Inc.	QualStaff Resources
Andersen Corporation	Gordon Ivan Townsend	R G Lynn Consulting LLC
ANSYS, Inc.	H4 Architects + Engineers	Renewable Energy Investment
AT&T	Halliburton Company	Rimkus

Atmos Energy Corporation	Hatch Tank	Riot Blockchain, Inc.
AWC, Inc.	HDR, Inc.	Riot Platforms, Inc.
Axiom Space, Inc.	Hewlett Packard Enterprise Development LP	Riviana Foods Inc.
Azoteq Inc.	HMH Industries, LLC	Rocking J Oil & Gas
AZZ Inc.	Hollinden Marketing Solutions, LLC	Rockwell Automation
BAE Systems, Inc.	HOLT Group	RS DesignSpark
Baker Concrete Construction	HOLT CAT	Rugged Robotics
Baker Hughes Company	Honeywell International Inc.	SageSensors
BASF	Houston Methodist Hospital	Saint-Gobain NorPro
Bay Area Houston Economic Partnership - SATOP	HP Inc.	Samsung Austin Semiconductor
Baylor Scott & White Health	HPE	Sandia National Laboratories
Bechtel Corporation	HSB Solomon Associates LLC	Schlumberger
Bell Textron Inc.	HTRI (Heat Transfer Research, Inc.)	SeatonHill Partners, LP
Big Data Energy Services, Inc.	Hummingbird Aero LLC	ServiceNow
Bill.com	IBM	SICK, Inc.
BIOTRONIK Inc. (website doesn't Inc. but a gov page does)	Igloo Products Corp.	Siemens
Bleyle Engineering	IGT Corporation	Sogeti / Cap Gemini
BMNT Inc.	Improving	Solomon Bruce Consulting LLC
Bray International, Inc.	indie Semiconductor, Inc.	Spindletop Capital
Burns & McDonnell	Indus Valley Partners	STAR
CAI	Innovative Compliance, Inc.	Starbright Engineering LLC
Cargill, Incorporated	Insight Enterprises, Inc.	Stratasys
Caterpillar Inc.	Jacobs	Stress Engineering Services, Inc.

CERTEX USA	JD3 Consulting, LLC	T STAR Engineering LLC
Chameleon Consulting Group, LLC	Keystone Engineering Inc.	Targa Resources Corp.
ChampionX Corporation	Kiewit Corporation	TC Energy
Chevron Phillips Chemical Company LLC	Kinder Morgan	TechnipFMC plc
Cognascent Consulting Group, Inc.	KPM Consulting	TEGRIDY INVESTMENTS LLC
Collins Aerospace	Kubota Tractor Corporation	Tenaris
Commissioning Agents, Inc.	L3Harris Technologies, Inc.	Texas A&M University
ConocoPhillips Company	Law Office of William Shaw	Texas Children's Hospital
Corebridge Financial, Inc.	Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory	Texas Instruments, Inc.
Corning Inc.	LCRA (Lower Colorado River Authority)	The Boeing Company
Covestro AG	Lockheed Martin Space	The Charles Schwab Corporation
Custom Air Products & Services Inc.	Los Alamos National Laboratory	The Texas Commission on Environmental Quality
Daikin Comfort Technologies North America, Inc.	Major Upgrades LLC	Torc Robotics
Darling Ingredients Inc.	Mantech, Inc.	Total Safety
Dell Technologies, Inc.	Mary Kay Global	TotalEnergies
Deloitte Consulting LLP	Mauser Packaging Solutions	Trane Technologies plc
Delta Structural Technology, LLC	Maverick Concepts LLC	Transocean Ltd.
DEVCOM Army Research Laboratory	McCord Engineering, Inc.	Trimasys Control Solutions Pvt Ltd.
Diligent Corporation	Micro Systems Engineering Inc.	U.S. Army
DIRECTV, LLC	Microsoft	U.S. Navy
Dow Chemical Company	MiTek Inc.	Vantedge Search
Dragon Habit LLC	Multi-Dimensional Integration	Veeco Instruments Inc.
Dril-Quip, Inc.	NASA	VeraErnest Inc.



Dynamic Analysis Group LLC	National Instruments Corp.	Versabar, Inc.
EDP Engineers and Inspectors LLC	Naval Nuclear Laboratory	Viasat, Inc.
Elbit Systems of America, LLC	Nichols Engineering LLC	Western Digital Technologies, Inc.
ELLWOOD Texas Forge Navasota	NL Enterprises, LLC	Westlake Corporation
Emerson	Nokia	Williams
Emerson Automation Solutions	NOV Inc.	Wood E&I
Endeavor Energy Resources, LP	Nova Inc.	Woodpecker Microsystems LLC
Endotronix, Inc.	Nucor	Würth Additive Group
Energy Investment and Development	Occidental Petroleum Corp.	Zimmer Biomet Holdings, Inc.
Engineering Controls Technologies	Oil States International, Inc.	